

Icons and styling

The iPhone maybe an iconic phone, but the new icons are a far cry from what they once were. Now we know that Johnny Ive believes in simplicity, but some of the icons are so childishly simple and plain that they seem to detract from the design more than anything else. This is of course a matter of debate, some people do love the icons, but the majority don't. The Safari icon in particular is the worst offender. Third-party developers have done a far better job of creating icons that are compatible with iOS7's design without being childishly plain like some of the default icons.

The excessively plain styling extends beyond the icons too.

The overall design of the OS seems to be one of beauty in simplicity but somehow, it seems more hit and miss than a well-defined experience. There are moments when it all comes together and you can truly appreciate the OS that Ive envisioned, but it's not always apparent and we truly wish that Apple spent just a bit more time and effort in properly bringing their dream to life.



A 5th grade art class assignment?

Animations

iOS 7 brought a great many animations with it to the table and while they do have some novelty value, they detract from the functionality of the device. Everything takes a second or two to respond because iOS is busy trying to show you how pretty it is. This is particularly painful when you're shifting apps between folders. Unlike Android, where you can disable or speed-up the animations, you can do nothing of the sort in iOS. In fact, a sentiment that we share with many other reviewers is that all these animations tend to feel like lag rather than cohesive parts of a spiffy interface.